

VoiceCart AI — “Softly” Design Spec

Full token + component implementation spec, mapped to the actual codebase (src/index.css CSS variables + real component class names). Hand this directly to Antigravity.

The current app already routes almost everything through CSS custom properties in src/index.css (--bg-primary, --accent-primary, --radius-*, etc.), so this is primarily a **token swap** plus a handful of component-level treatments — not a rewrite. One thing to flag for Antigravity up front: a few places (e.g. .nav-tab-btn.active) hardcode #059669 directly instead of using the variable — those need to be changed manually since they won't pick up the new token automatically.

1. Color Tokens — replace :root in src/index.css

Light theme (“Softly Day”) — replaces the existing light block:

Swatch	Token	Usage
	--bg-primary #FDFCF8	Main canvas background
	--bg-surface #FFFFFF	Cards, header, modals
	--bg-elevated #F5F2EA	Elevated panels, nav pill track
	--bg-card #FFFFFF	Item cards, widget cards
	--bg-card-hover #FDF9F4	Card hover state
	--accent-sage #E8EFE8	Secondary accent — success/positive states
	--accent-lavender #EDEDFA	Tertiary accent — info/neutral states
	--accent-primary #FFB7B2	PRIMARY accent — replaces emerald. CTAs, active nav, voice orb
	--text-primary #292524	Primary text (soft-black, not pure black)
	--text-muted #78716C	Secondary/meta text
	--border-glass #E7E2D8	Card borders — warm, not cool-gray

Dark theme (“Softly Dusk”) — the source style is light-only, so this is an adapted dark variant to preserve the app's existing light/dark toggle without breaking the aesthetic:

Swatch	Token	Usage
	--bg-primary #1C1917	Dark canvas — warm charcoal, not blue-black
	--bg-surface #26221E	Dark cards/header
	--bg-elevated #332D27	Dark elevated panels
	--accent-primary #FF9E97	Brightened coral for dark-mode contrast
	--text-primary #F5F1EA	Warm off-white text
	--text-muted #A8A29E	Muted warm gray

Radius scale — Softly uses much larger radii than the current app. Update:

```
--radius-sm: 12px; /* was 8px */
--radius-md: 18px; /* was 12px */
--radius-lg: 24px; /* was 16px */
--radius-xl: 32px; /* was 20px */
--radius-2xl: 40px; /* was 24px */
```

Shadows — soften and warm them (remove the cool slate tint):

```
--shadow-sm: 0 2px 8px rgba(41, 37, 36, 0.04);
--shadow-md: 0 4px 20px -2px rgba(41, 37, 36, 0.06);
--shadow-lg: 0 12px 32px -4px rgba(41, 37, 36, 0.08);
--shadow-glow: 0 0 24px rgba(255, 183, 178, 0.35); /* coral glow, replaces green */
```

2. Typography

Replace the Inter + JetBrains Mono pairing with Softly's Outfit + Reenie Beanie. Keep a mono font for the NLP Lab's structured/technical output only — Softly's brief doesn't cover code display, and losing monospace there would hurt readability of JSON/AST output.

```
@import url('https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?
family=Outfit:wght@300;400;500;600;700;800
&family;=Reenie+Beanie&family;=JetBrains+Mono:wght@400;500;600
&display;=swap');

--font-sans: 'Outfit', -apple-system, sans-serif;
--font-accent: 'Reenie Beanie', cursive; /* NEW — use sparingly */
--font-mono: 'JetBrains Mono', monospace; /* keep, NLP Lab only */
```

- Headline sizes (VoiceAssistantHero title, empty-state headers): 48–64px, Outfit 700, tracking -0.02em, sentence case (not the current title case).
- Use Reenie Beanie **only** for one or two expressive accents — e.g. the VoiceOrb's idle-state subtitle (“Listening...” could get a small cursive flourish underneath), or a hand-written-style callout in empty states. Do not apply it to buttons, nav, or data — it will hurt legibility/scanability in list-dense views.

3. Global Texture — Grain Overlay

Softly's signature texture is a persistent 35%-opacity SVG noise overlay across the whole app, giving the flat pastel palette a tactile, paper-like feel instead of looking like generic flat design.

- Add a fixed, full-viewport `<div class="grain-over lay">` once in App.tsx (sibling to `.app-container`), not per-component.
- z-index above content, `pointer-events: none, mix-blend-mode: over lay, opacity 0.35`.
- SVG filter: `feTurbulence baseFrequency 0.65, type="fractalNoise"`.
- Turn opacity down to ~0.15–0.18 in dark mode — 0.35 will look muddy on the darker “Softly Dusk” background.

```
.grain-overlay {
  position: fixed; inset: 0; z-index: 50;
  pointer-events: none; mix-blend-mode: over lay;
  opacity: 0.35;
  background-image: url("data:image/svg+xml,...feTurbulence...");
}
[data-theme="dark"] .grain-overlay { opacity: 0.16; }
```

4. Background Blobs

Softly's hero areas use large, blurred, softly floating gradient blobs behind content. Apply this specifically behind the VoiceAssistantHero / VoiceOrb — it's the app's true “hero” moment and the natural place for this effect. Do **not** add blobs behind the ShoppingListView or Insights — dense data views need a calm, static background so text stays scannable.

- Two blurred blobs (140–220px radius, 60% opacity) using `--accent-sage` and `--accent-lavender`, positioned behind VoiceOrb.
- Slow floating animation: 6s ease-in-out loop, `translateY ±10px` — matches Softly's “low-velocity, intentionally slow” brief. Avoid anything faster; speed would clash with the calm tone.

5. Component-Level Treatment (mapped to your actual files)

5.1 Header & Nav — src/components/Header.tsx

src/components/Header.tsx · .header-container, .logo-icon-wrapper, .nav-tabs-wrapper, .nav-tab-btn

- Header background: --bg-surface (pure white) stays, but soften border to --border-glass (warm E7E2D8) and bump border-radius to --radius-xl for the floating-pill look Softly uses for nav.
- .logo-icon-wrapper: swap the mic icon accent color from emerald to --accent-primary (coral #FFB7B2), background tint at 15% opacity coral instead of green.
- .nav-tab-btn.active hardcodes background: #059669 directly in two places (light + dark theme block) — replace both literal hex values with coral, since these won't inherit from the variable change automatically.
- Reduce nav-tab-btn font-weight slightly (600 → 500) to match Outfit's softer, rounder letterforms — 600 will look heavy in this font.

5.2 Voice Orb — src/components/VoiceAssistant/VoiceOrb.tsx

src/components/VoiceAssistant/VoiceOrb.tsx · .voice-orb-button, .orb-wave (wave-1/2/3)

- This is the single highest-impact component for the Softly aesthetic. Base orb fill: coral gradient (#FFB7B2 → #FF9E97), replacing whatever the current listening/idle gradient is.
- .orb-wave ripple rings on the 'listening' state: switch from a sharp pulse to Softly's slower 6s-style easing — softer, larger, more translucent rings using sage/lavender at low opacity rather than a single hard accent color.
- 'Processing' state (Loader2 spin): keep spin, but recolor to lavender rather than the current accent so state changes read as a soft palette shift rather than a color-scheme jump.
- 'Error' state: keep semantically red/warning, but use a desaturated warm rose rather than pure red, staying inside the Softly palette family.
- Add the background blobs from section 4 directly behind .voice-orb-wrapper.

5.3 Shopping List & Item Cards — src/components/ShoppingList/

ShoppingListView.tsx, ShoppingItemCard.tsx, CategorySection.tsx · .item-card, .checkbox-custom, .tag-badge, .recurring-badge

- .item-card: radius --radius-lg (24px, up from 16px), border --border-glass, subtle --shadow-sm on hover only (Softly favors flat-until-interaction over always-elevated cards).
- .checkbox-custom.checked: fill with --accent-primary (coral) instead of emerald; checkmark stays white.
- .tag-badge (dietary tags): background --accent-sage at full opacity with --text-primary text, rounded-full — these read as gentle informational chips rather than warning-style badges.
- .recurring-badge.active: background --accent-lavender instead of current accent — keeps it visually distinct from the primary coral CTA color so it doesn't compete for attention.
- Category section headers: consider a light hand-written accent (Reenie Beanie, small size) next to the category emoji/icon as a one-off personality touch — but only here, not repeated elsewhere.

5.4 Sidebar Widgets — src/components/Sidebar/

BudgetTrackerWidget.tsx, RestockWidget.tsx · .sidebar-panel, .budget-top, .cat-progress-fill/-track

- .cat-progress-fill: replace solid accent fill with a coral→peach gradient matching the orb, so the budget bar and voice orb feel like the same design language.
- .budget-top amount text: keep large/bold in Outfit, but drop tracking-tight since Softly headlines lean slightly looser than the current tight tracking.
- Card containers: --radius-lg, remove any hard 1px cool-gray borders in favor of --border-glass.

5.5 Insights, History, NLP Lab — src/components/Insights/, History/, NlpLab/

InsightsView.tsx, HistoryView.tsx, NlpPlaygroundView.tsx

- These are your most data-dense screens — apply Softly's palette/radius/shadow tokens, but do NOT apply grain overlay opacity above 0.2 here and skip decorative blobs entirely; readability of charts/logs/JSON takes priority over atmosphere.
- NLP Lab's JSON/AST output block: keep `--font-mono` (JetBrains Mono) on a slightly warm-tinted code background (`--bg-elevated` with the new warm tone) rather than switching it to Outfit — technical output needs monospace.
- Chart colors (InsightsView): remap the department/category color set to a Softly-consistent palette — coral, sage, lavender, plus 2–3 supporting muted tones — instead of the current more saturated set, so charts don't clash with the rest of the UI.

5.6 Modals — `src/components/Modals/`

`CatalogModal.tsx`, `SmartSuggestionsModal.tsx`, `BuildMyListModal.tsx`, `HelpModal.tsx`

- `.build-list-modal`, `.catalog-card` etc.: bump radius to `--radius-2xl` for the modal shell itself (Softly likes very rounded containers, 2–4rem), keep inner cards at `--radius-lg`.
- Modal backdrop: warm-tinted scrim (`rgba(41,37,36,0.4)`) instead of a neutral/cool black overlay, consistent with the ink color token.
- `.btn-primary-action` / `.btn-build-list-action`: coral fill, pill radius (`--radius-full`), soft shadow on hover matching `--shadow-glow`.

5.7 Toast Notifications — `src/components/UI/ToastContainer.tsx`

`ToastContainer.tsx`

- Switch toast background from solid dark/neutral to `--bg-surface` with a colored left border (coral for success/undo, warm amber for warnings) rather than a fully colored toast body — keeps it consistent with Softly's restrained, mostly-neutral card style.

6. Motion

- Global transition speed: slow slightly from the current --transition-fast (0.15s) — Softly's brief is explicitly "low-velocity." Consider adding a --transition-soft: 0.4s cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1) for card reveals and view transitions.
- Reveal-on-mount for list items / view switches: translateY 20px → 0, opacity 0 → 1, ~0.6–0.8s — apply to ShoppingListView category groups and Insights charts on first render.
- Avoid adding this slow-reveal motion to frequently-repeated micro-interactions (checkbox toggle, quantity stepper) — those should stay fast/snappy so the app doesn't feel sluggish during actual voice-driven use.

7. Implementation Order for Antigravity

Step	Task	Why this order
1	Swap :root color + radius + shadow tokens (Section 1)	Cascades everywhere instantly; biggest visual delta for least effort
2	Fix hardcoded #059669 in .nav-tab-btn.active (both theme blocks)	Otherwise the active nav tab stays green after step 1 — most visible leftover bug
3	Swap fonts + import (Section 2)	Changes feel/rhythm of every screen at once
4	Voice Orb treatment (5.2)	Highest-visibility single component; the app's hero moment
5	Grain overlay + hero blobs (Sections 3–4)	Needs the base palette in place first to look intentional, not muddy
6	Remaining component passes (5.1, 5.3–5.7)	Mechanical once tokens/fonts are set
7	Motion pass (Section 6)	Polish layer, do last so timing feels right against final visuals

Note: a folder named VoiceCart_AI_Redesign was found inside the uploaded zip alongside the main project — worth confirming with Antigravity which one is the actual target before applying this spec, in case work has already diverged between the two.